

01 Get it

02 Trust it

03 Use it

04 Stretch it

MCP 101 · USE IT · SWAP CARDS

Instead of this, *do this*

19 swaps across three roles for the habits that keep Claude and Backstory from doing their best work.

People keep their old habits and *bolt Claude onto the end of them.*

Every card in this set applies one of three swaps.

01

Ask, don't gather

Instead of opening six tabs before a call, ask for the brief.

02

Pull live, don't paste

Instead of pasting CRM notes into Claude, let it pull them live, so nothing goes stale.

03

Be specific, not general

Instead of "How's my pipeline?", ask a question with a filter, a time window and a signal.

ROLE 01 · 7 SWAPS

Account executive

Prep, follow-up and deal strategy, without the tab hunt.

- 01 Pre-call prep
- 02 Deal updates
- 03 Pipeline check
- 04 Follow-up email
- 05 Stakeholder map
- 06 Deal risk
- 07 Precedent



Pre-call prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Opening six tabs before a call: CRM, inbox, calendar and last week's recording.



DO THIS

“Brief me on Vantage Retail: last three meetings, open risks, anyone who's gone quiet.”

WHY IT WORKS

One ask replaces the hunt, and every line comes from captured activity.



Deal updates

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF THIS

Pasting CRM notes into Claude and hoping they're current.



DO THIS

“Using Backstory, what’s changed on Vantage Retail since last Tuesday?”

WHY IT WORKS

It pulls the record live, so nothing goes stale.



Pipeline check

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

“How’s my pipeline?”



DO THIS

“Which of my deals closing this quarter have no exec contact in 30 days?”

WHY IT WORKS

A filter, a time window and a signal turn a vague answer into a to-do list.



Follow-up email

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Rewatching the call to write the recap.



DO THIS

“Using Backstory, draft a follow-up to my last Vantage Retail meeting with the next steps we agreed.”

WHY IT WORKS

The meeting is already captured. Start from it, not from memory.



Stakeholder map

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

Rebuilding the buying group from memory.



DO THIS

“Who at Vantage Retail have we met with in the last 90 days, and who’s missing from the buying group?”

WHY IT WORKS

It shows who’s engaged and who isn’t, based on real meetings.

Deal risk

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

“Is this deal okay?”



DO THIS

“What are the top three risks on the Vantage Retail opportunity, and what’s the evidence for each?”

WHY IT WORKS

Asking for evidence keeps the answer tied to the record.



Precedent

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Asking around Slack for someone who's closed a deal like this.



DO THIS

“Find an open deal similar to Vantage Retail and tell me how it was won.”

WHY IT WORKS

Situation search finds comparable past deals. Available where your workspace has it enabled.



ROLE 02 · 6 SWAPS

Sales manager

Forecast, inspect and coach from the record, not the recap.

01 Forecast prep

02 1:1 prep

03 Deal inspection

04 Coaching focus

05 At-risk accounts

06 Win patterns



Forecast prep

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF THIS

Exporting the pipeline to a spreadsheet before the forecast call.



DO THIS

“Using Backstory, which deals in my team’s commit changed stage or close date this week?”

WHY IT WORKS

You walk in knowing what moved, without rebuilding the view.



1:1 prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Asking the rep to walk through every deal.



DO THIS

“Before my 1:1 with Priya, summarize her top five deals: recent activity, risks and next steps.”

WHY IT WORKS

The 1:1 starts at the conversation, not the status update.



Deal inspection

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

“Is Halden Freight going to close?”



DO THIS

“Evaluate the Halden Freight opportunity using MEDDPICC and flag the gaps.”

WHY IT WORKS

A framework gives the answer a structure you can coach against.



Coaching focus

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

Coaching from gut feel on who's struggling.



DO THIS

“Which reps have deals with no customer meeting in the last 21 days?”

WHY IT WORKS

Activity gaps point to where coaching will matter most.



At-risk accounts

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

Reading every call summary to find the accounts going cold.



DO THIS

“Which accounts on my team have gone quiet in the last 30 days, ranked by deal size?”

WHY IT WORKS

Ranking by size tells you where to look first.



Win patterns

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Relying on anecdotes for what's working.



DO THIS

“Across deals my team won last quarter, what did the buying groups have in common?”

WHY IT WORKS

Scoped to one quarter and one team, the pattern is specific enough to act on.



ROLE 03 · 6 SWAPS

Customer success

Renewals, handoffs and account health, with the full story in hand.

- 01 Renewal prep
- 02 QBR prep
- 03 Sales handoff
- 04 Quiet contacts
- 05 Book health
- 06 Expansion



Renewal prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Piecing the renewal story together the week before.



DO THIS

“Using Backstory, summarize Corvia Health’s last 90 days: meetings, open issues and renewal risks.”

WHY IT WORKS

The story is already in the activity. Ask for it early.



QBR prep

Ask, don't gather

INSTEAD OF THIS

Building the QBR deck from a blank page.



DO THIS

“Draft a QBR outline for Corvia Health from this quarter’s meetings and emails.”

WHY IT WORKS

Start from what the customer actually said this quarter.



Sales handoff

Pull live, don't paste

INSTEAD OF THIS

A 30-minute handoff call to learn what was promised.



DO THIS

“Summarize what was promised to Corvia Health during the sales cycle: goals, commitments and open questions.”

WHY IT WORKS

Commitments made in meetings don't get lost between teams.



Quiet contacts

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

Finding out your champion left when an email bounces.



DO THIS

“Which contacts at Corvia Health used to be active and have gone quiet?”

WHY IT WORKS

You see the drop-off while there's still time to act.

Book health

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

Scanning your book account by account.



DO THIS

“Which of my accounts renewing in the next 90 days have had no meeting in 45 days?”

WHY IT WORKS

Two filters turn a whole book into a short list.



Expansion

Be specific, not general

INSTEAD OF THIS

“Any expansion opportunities?”



DO THIS

“Which teams at Corvia Health have we met with outside the original buying group this quarter?”

WHY IT WORKS

New conversations outside the core team are the earliest expansion signal.



EVERY SWAP, ONE HABIT

Name the tool. Scope the ask. *Ask for receipts.*

Accounts, reps and deals shown are mock examples: Vantage Retail, Halden Freight, Corvia Health.

